

JOSEPH POINTER

AI Adoption and Enablement | Champion Networks, Role-Based Training, Measured Use | Building and Directing AI Agents

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PROFILE

Most AI investments fail at adoption rather than at technology. I take AI from identified use cases to changed ways of working. The work I own is what happens after the tool is available. At TIAA (\$1.5T AUM) I conceived a 9-module AI-powered career development platform, led the team that built it, and owned it from use-case scoping through responsible-use limits, phased rollout, champion networks, and measurement. I ran one adoption operating model across seven Client Services business areas whose leaders did not report to me. Before TIAA I spent a decade inside professional services delivering to Fortune 500 clients. I am not an engineer. I build and direct AI agents with my own hands, and I can tell an engineering team what good looks like.

AGENTS AND AI WORKFLOWS I HAVE BUILT, OUTSIDE OF AN EMPLOYER

- **A four-agent interview simulator, running today.** Inside CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), which I designed and directed the build of. Four agents run in sequence with no human between the steps, analyzing a job description against a resume, designing a tailored question set, scoring answers in real time and deciding when to probe harder, then writing the coaching report. I owned what the system is not allowed to decide, which is why it hands a coaching report to a person rather than judging whether anyone is qualified. CareerPointers is live and in use, and I have not marketed it. Mike Pointer is co-founder and engineered the production backend, the databases and security that made this and Future Me, Answered real.
- **A standing team of AI agents I operate daily, not a demo.** Each agent holds a defined role, its own rules, and a named gate, including an adversarial reviewer whose job is to attack the output before it ships. Before changing which model each agent runs on I wrote down what degradation would look like and set a revert-first rule, so the failure criteria existed before the change did. The gates catch overclaims on their way into live work, and they miss things, which is why a person still signs it. I configure and direct them without writing code, and I published the methodology behind the practice in 2026.
- **Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com), live.** I designed the 5-stage discovery framework, structured career data across 922 occupations, and developed most of the application by directing AI, on Next.js with multi-provider AI so I could move providers if one degraded. It is in use by dozens of people on donated access.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - July 2026

TIAA, Denver, CO. Fortune 100 financial services, \$1.5T AUM, fiduciary duty under ERISA and SEC oversight.

With TIAA since May 2011. Business Manager (2016-2022) | Senior Business Management Specialist (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

AI From Use Case to Company-Wide Adoption

- **Took an AI platform from an idea to a company-wide launch.** I conceived a 9-module AI-powered career development platform and led the team that built it, first for a major transformation population and then across the company. I owned use-case scoping and prioritization, phased rollout, responsible-use standards, adoption strategy, and impact measurement. 16,000+ associates had access to it.
- **Seven business areas running one operating model, none of them mine.** I connected seven Client Services business areas through named liaisons, shared strategy, and peer learning, and moved each from pilot to a sustained way of working. Enablement, acceptable-use standards, and measurement ran from one place while every area kept ownership of its own use cases. I set the operating rhythm, the prioritization, and the resource calls.

Enablement, Champions, and Training

- **Built the champion network that carried adoption.** I named a liaison in each business area, and the use cases that mattered came back from them rather than from me. I reached 1,500+ associates directly across 30+ town halls, team sessions, and one-on-one coaching I ran myself, because you cannot send an email and call it adoption.
- **Shipped the enablement alongside the tool, not after it.** Prompt guidance and role-based materials went out with the platform rather than leaving uptake to a launch announcement. Different roles got different starting points, because a people leader and a front-line associate do not need the same first ten minutes.

Governance, Measurement, and Budget

- **Set the hard limits that let AI ship inside a regulated business.** I explored and prototyped first, then brought Risk, Compliance, and Legal in to set the limits once an idea was worth building. No client data or PII was allowed to be entered into the platform. No AI-initiated actions. Guided prompts and human oversight that keep a person in control of the decision. The system generated. It never acted.
- **Measured adoption as active use, not headcount with access.** I defined the success measures, tracked them, and carried progress, trade-offs, and prioritization decisions to senior leaders through executive read-outs, people-leader updates, and quarterly business reviews. Reach is not adoption and access is not usage, and I reported the difference rather than the flattering number.
- **Found the permission exposure any assistant would inherit.** I owned SharePoint governance across a 125-site estate and remediated 1,763 files flagged for PII with IT. An assistant surfaces to a person everything they already have permission to reach, so permission sprawl is a day-one exposure rather than a later phase.
- **Built and negotiated a \$300K annual Client Services engagement budget with Finance,** inside roughly \$500K of Client Services program spend I administered, then showed what it bought.
- **Graded vendors when the money was real.** I held a seat on the corporate team that selected an enterprise recognition platform, helping write the RFP and grading every proposal and finalist presentation. The evaluation discipline is what transfers.

Sales Engineer, Information Architect, Instructional Designer

January 2001 - March 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent Human Capital, Denver, CO.

- **A decade inside professional services, on the sales side of enterprise deals.** Continuous tenure through a chain of acquisitions. I was the sales engineer on the team and built what the reps used to win, scoping capability needs and shaping multi-year implementation plans for Unilever, Bank of America, Verizon Wireless, GE Capital, and Regions Bank. I know how a services firm sells and delivers, because I worked inside one for ten years.

CAPABILITIES

AI Enablement and Adoption: Use-Case Intake, Assessment and Prioritization | Pilot-to-Production Scaling | Adoption KPIs and Baselines | Champion Networks and Communities of Practice | AI Literacy and Role-Based Training | Workshop Facilitation and Demonstrations | Agentic and Multi-Agent LLM Workflows | Prompt Design and Reusable Templates | Hands-on across Claude, Microsoft 365 Copilot, ChatGPT, Amazon Q Developer

Governance and Risk Partnership: Responsible AI and Acceptable-Use Standards | Risk, Compliance and Legal Partnership | Human-Review Design | Permission and Access Exposure Review | Data Privacy Remediation | Change Management

Program and Executive: Executive Read-Outs and Quarterly Business Reviews | Engagement Budget Ownership | Vendor Selection and RFP Scoring (Recognition Platform) | Cross-Functional Leadership Without Line Authority | Enterprise Software Delivery | Microsoft 365 and SharePoint Governance

EDUCATION AND RECOGNITION

M.S. Instructional Technology, Bloomsburg University, PA (4.0 GPA) | B.A. Art, Millersville University, PA
Three-time TIAA Values Champion (2022, 2025, 2026) | Face of TIAA, one of four individuals recognized that month (2025) | Change Champion (2025)